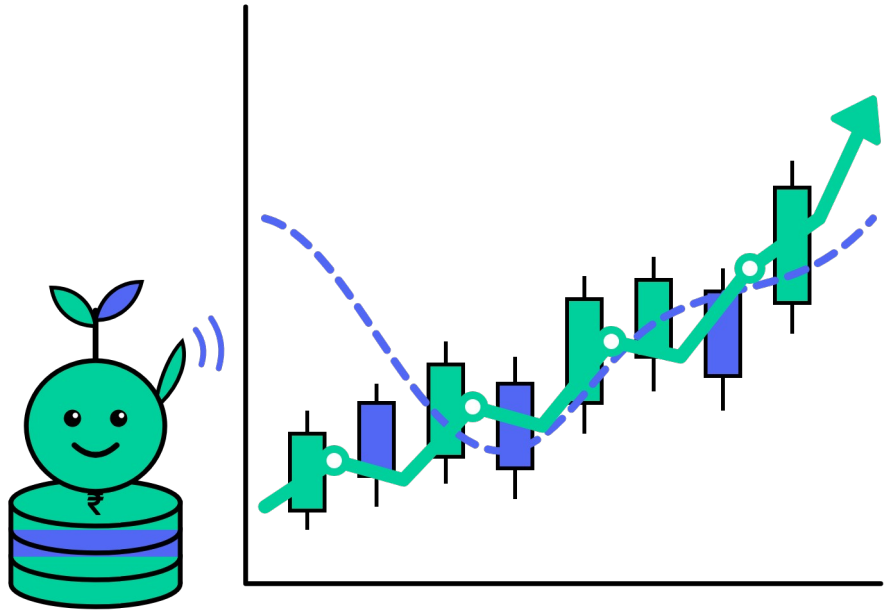
NextLeap graduation project | Growth PM case: Groww

Helping first-time Groww investors stay invested through year one



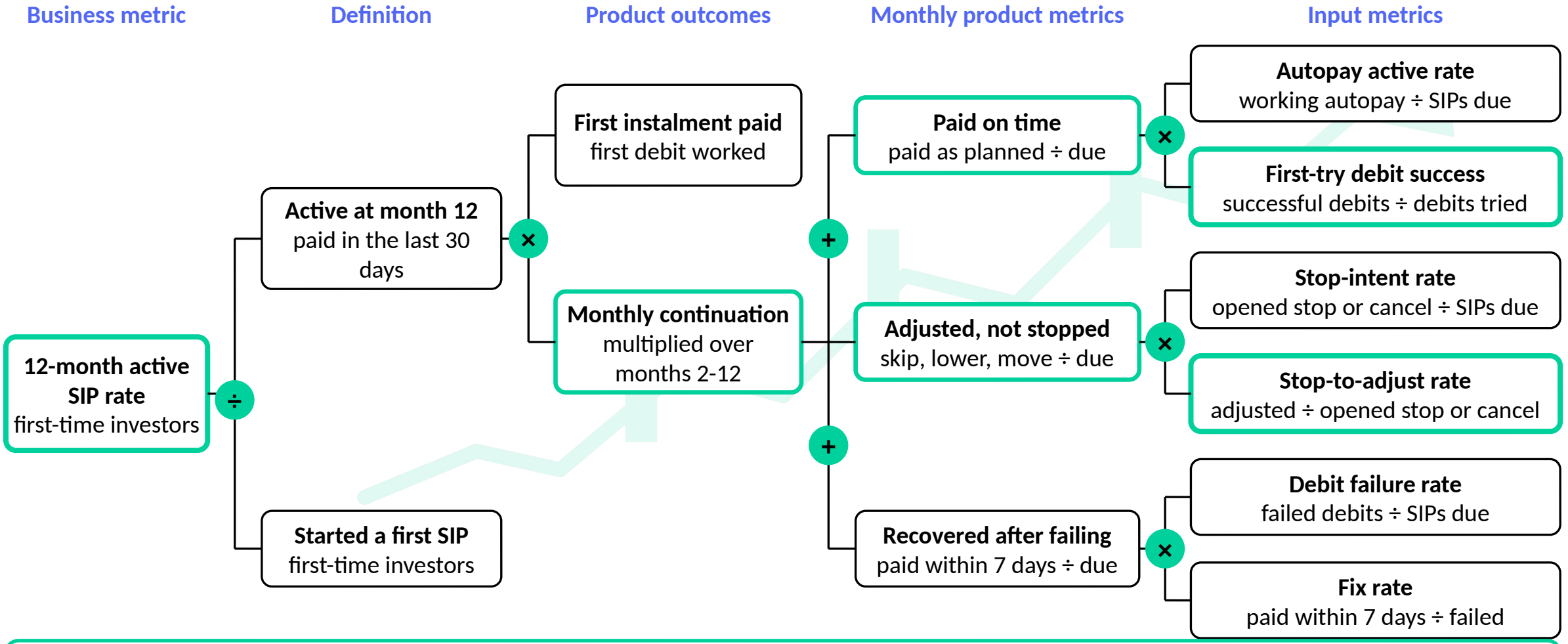
Why early-career salaried investors wobble in months 2 to 12, and an AI check-in that steadies them without giving advice

North-star metric: percentage of first-time mutual fund investors who still have an active SIP 12 months after starting their first one.

11,711 conversations analysed | 4,952 about real SIP journeys | 18-person survey | Try the live AI discovery engine

Independent study. Not affiliated with Groww; Groww logo shown for identification only. Not investment advice. Mutual fund investments are subject to market risks.

KPI tree: the 12-month active SIP rate comes down to whether each monthly instalment is paid, adjusted or recovered



Steady SIP continuity can be increased by the first-try debit success rate and the stop-to-adjust rate.
The first keeps money flowing every month with no effort from the investor; the second turns a decision to leave into a smaller step.

Impact mapping: of about 2 to 3 million first-time Groww SIP investors a year, early-career salaried 22 to 30 are the largest group

India's population ~1.4 billion

Mobile internet users ~958 million
68% of population | IAMAI 2025

Fintech app users 500M+ UPI users
~52% of internet users | NPCI-BCG 2025

Groww active users 16.7 million
~3% of UPI users | Groww Q4 FY26 letter

First-time SIP investors on Groww
~2 to 3 million a year (estimate)

Students, under 22	Largest group Salaried, 22-30	Variable income	Mid-career, 31+
29% of first-timers	51% of first-timers	12% of first-timers	8% of first-timers
~580K-870K a year	~1.0M-1.5M a year	~240K-360K a year	~160K-240K a year

The entry door
36% of new Groww users start with a SIP (Q2 FY26, up 7 points on last year). For many, the first SIP is their first product on Groww.

The leak
SIP stoppage ratio 78.5% in Sep 2026: 63.26 lakh new SIPs vs 49.68 lakh closed or completed. Acquisition works; keeping SIPs alive is the gap.

Estimate logic
~10M of 16.7M users hold mutual funds; 20-30% assumed to start a first SIP in a year. Segment shares: engine, first-year posts stating age or income.

Sources: IAMAI 2025 | NPCI-BCG | **Groww letter Q4 FY26** | Groww letter Q2 FY26 | SIP stoppage Sep 2026

How the evidence was built: an AI discovery engine reads 11,711 real conversations and is tested against a golden set

1 Collect

40,000 Play Store reviews, 38.5K Reddit posts and 15.9K comments, 15.8K YouTube comments. Public data only; no personal or account data.

2 Filter and sample

Remove duplicates, keep SIP and mutual-fund talk, seeded sampling: 21,073 items. Spam and ads removed so each voice counts once.

3 AI extraction

Gemini codes each item: what happened, why, feeling, needs, why started, confusion, age. 11,711 analysed, 4,952 relevant

4 Check

Quotes must appear word for word (98.5%). A stricter prompt removed 28% false 'relevant' items such as ULIP and PPF

5 Answer (RAG)

Question, search terms, keyword and meaning search, AI re-rank, 2 to 3 sentence answer, four self-checks. Answers that fail a check are hidden.

6 Evaluate

19/19 tricky questions handled; precision@5 43 to 78%; 11/12 answers grounded; hand-labelled golden set to score extraction

Next: 4 interviews with salaried first-time investors then tested what the public data showed: personas and hypothesis follow.
[Try the live engine]

Free-tier stack: Gemini models, Vercel hosting. Data: public reviews, posts and comments shown as short excerpts without usernames.

Personas: one missed SIPs, one faced low returns and a layoff; neither had guidance on what to do next

A · Akshata, 26 · Missed it, never meant to stop

"I did turn on the mandate auto debit because I kept forgetting to pay."

Demographics

26, salaried, salary on the 1st · first-ever mutual fund investment, first SIP in 2025 · one SIP of Rs 1,000 on the 1st

App usage

- Opens Groww only when the SIP payment is due
- Paid by hand at first; turned on autopay after missing
- Uses GR-1 to read the portfolio and trusts it fully
- Knows amount or date can change; has never used it

Key goals

- Long-term returns; expects more than 15% a year
- Keep the SIP going without having to remember it

Core friction points

- Forgot to pay: missed 2 to 3 instalments (not in a row)
- The one reminder gets lost among other notifications
- Did not know what several missed instalments lead to

P · Praveen, 34 · Laid off, nearly quit

"Pay less and postpone the SIP to next month." (what would have helped)

Demographics

34, salaried · first-ever mutual fund investment, first SIP about 4 months ago · SIP mid-month; salary date never a problem

App usage

- Opens Groww every morning to check the graph
- Has used skip (no confusion) and lowered the amount
- After the layoff, looked up how to stop the SIP
- Asks a friend or advisors; no AI, unaware of GR-1

Key goals

- Make money: expects at least 10% a year
- Wants the app to analyse and explain the portfolio

Core friction points

- Laid off and needed the money: the SIP nearly stopped
- Low returns and poor market knowledge made quitting tempting
- Did not know what several missed instalments lead to

Shared by all 4 interviewees: none knew what several missed instalments lead to; all 4 named a gentler path they would have taken

Validated hypothesis: SIPs stop because first-timers get no proper guidance when they miss a SIP or returns are low

Target segment: salaried, 22-30, the largest group at 51% of first-time investors who state age or income

1 Starts with intent
Own goal or a friend's nudge; expects 10% to 15%+ a year

→

2 Trigger moment
Misses a SIP (forgot, layoff, a move) or sees low returns

→

3 Root cause: no proper guidance
No one explains what a miss leads to, or what to do at low returns

→

4 Doesn't know what to do
Asks a friend, advisors, Reddit, or does nothing

→

5 The SIP breaks
Missed, stopped, or cancelled and redeemed

With no guidance at a missed SIP or a low-returns moment, investors don't know what to do, and the SIP stops.

What 4 interviews showed

- Missed SIP: none of the 4 knew what several misses lead to
- Low returns: 2 of 4 thought of quitting, unsure what else to do
- With no guide, they asked a friend, advisors or Reddit, or did nothing
- Asked for it: “a proper guide to first time SIP investors”; found GR-1 only later
- 4 of 4 named a gentler path: move the date, pay less, skip a month

How we got here, and where it points

Started with: a doubt goes unanswered in the app.

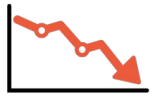
Sharpened to: the gap is guidance at two moments, a missed SIP and low returns. Consistent with all 4 interviews.

Points to: an in-app guide at those two moments: what a miss leads to, the gentler options, and why returns move in year one. It explains; it never recommends funds.

Why Groww can fix it: the app already knows each debit date and sees every return, so it can step in at the right moment.

Problem: when first-timers miss a SIP or see low returns, nothing guides them on what to do, so the SIP stops

1 What is the true problem?



Year one has two make-or-break moments: a missed instalment (forgot, laid off, moved) and a low-returns month. At both, first-timers don't know what a miss leads to, whether the returns are normal, or that they can skip, lower or move the SIP. Nothing in the app guides them then, so they ask friends or Reddit, freeze, or cancel.

2 Who faces it?

Salaried first-time investors, 22 to 30, in their first 12 months. 51% of first-timers who state age or income; about 1.0 to 1.5 million a year on Groww (estimate). Personas: Akshata and Praveen. Most started on a friend's or sibling's advice and rarely look for help on their own.

3 How do we know it is real?

- Hypothesis validated in 4 interviews: 0 of 4 knew what several misses lead to; 4 of 4 named a gentler path
- 57% of stated drop-off reasons sit at these two moments: missed SIPs 24%, low returns or confusing numbers 33% (n=230)
- A trusted answer is the top need in 54% of first-year posts

4 What value does solving it create?

For investors: at a missed SIP or a low-returns month, a clear answer to “what happens now, is this normal, what can I do”, and a gentler option than cancel.
For Groww: a higher 12-month active-SIP rate. Each +1 point keeps roughly 20,000 to 30,000 first-time investors a year (estimate), with fewer support contacts.
Why AI: each moment is personal (own numbers, own month), so one fixed FAQ cannot answer it; a checked AI can, for millions.

5 Why solve it now?

- Acquisition works, retention lags: record Rs 32,490 crore monthly SIPs, yet a 78.5% stoppage ratio (Sep 2026)
- 36% of new Groww users start SIP-first, so more first-timers reach these moments
- The pieces exist (skip, lower amount, GR-1) but don't appear at the moment: Akshata found GR-1 only later

SIPal flow 1: a weekly check-in shows how the SIP did and why the market moved, in a good week or a bad one

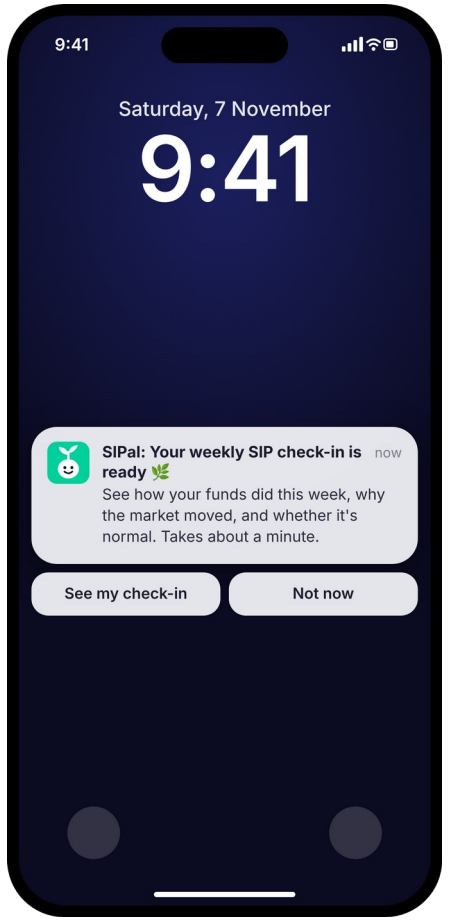
The pitch

"A calm guide that comes to you every week, when your SIP misses a payment or your returns dip, and tells you what happened, whether it's normal, and what you can do."

How it works

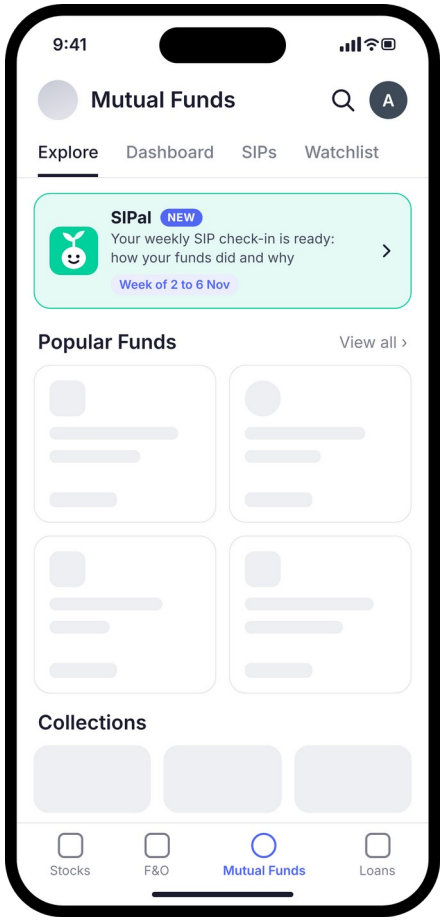
- A weekly notification or the Explore entry opens it
- Own numbers, why the market moved, is it normal
- AI words facts from data; checked, or a safe fallback

Numbers in the screens are illustrative.



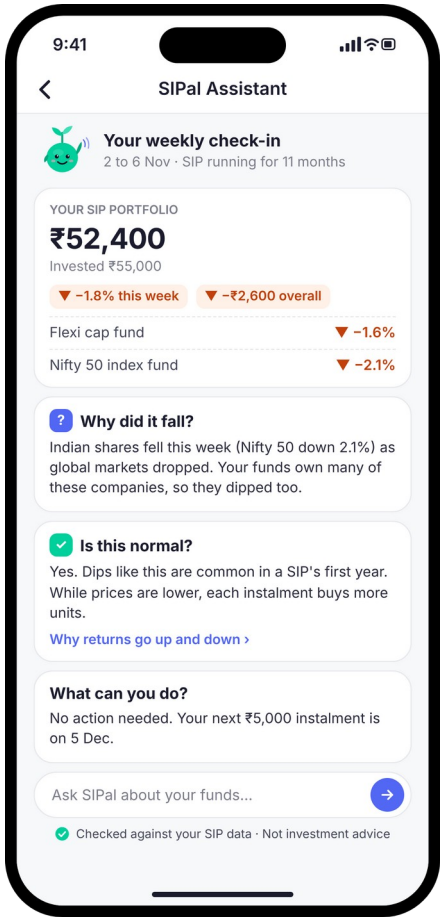
1 Weekly notification

No amounts on the lock screen



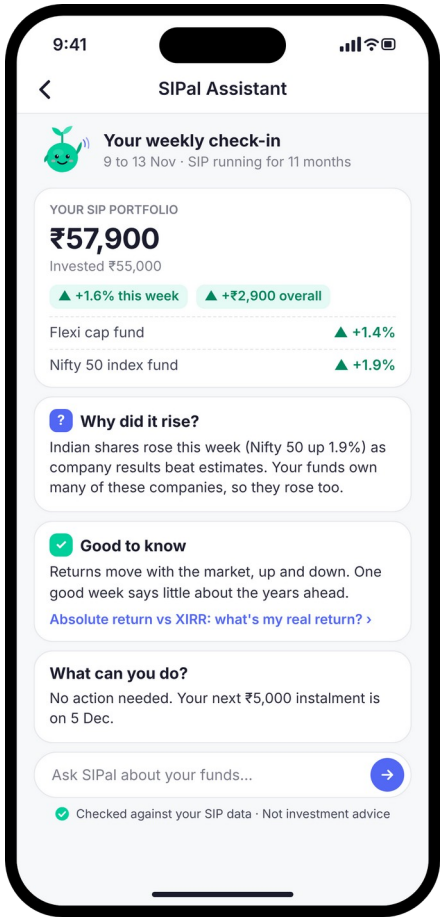
2 Or: Explore entry

Open it from Explore, any time



3 Down week

Own funds, why, and is it normal



4 Up week

Same calm story on a rise

SIPal flow 2: three days before the debit, SIPal asks if this month is OK and lets them pay less just once

Fixes the missed-SIP moment

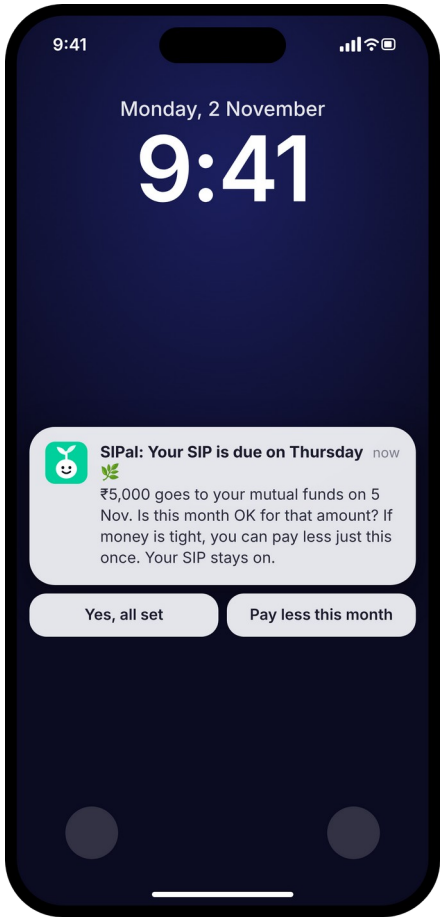
- A reminder 3 days ahead, while a change can still go through
- Pay less this month only; next month goes back on its own
- Says what changes: SIP stays active, no penalty

Built from what users asked for

"A proper reminder a day before the due date" (Akshata)
"Pay less and postpone the SIP" (Praveen)
"Prior notification... to manage money better" (Sudhanva)

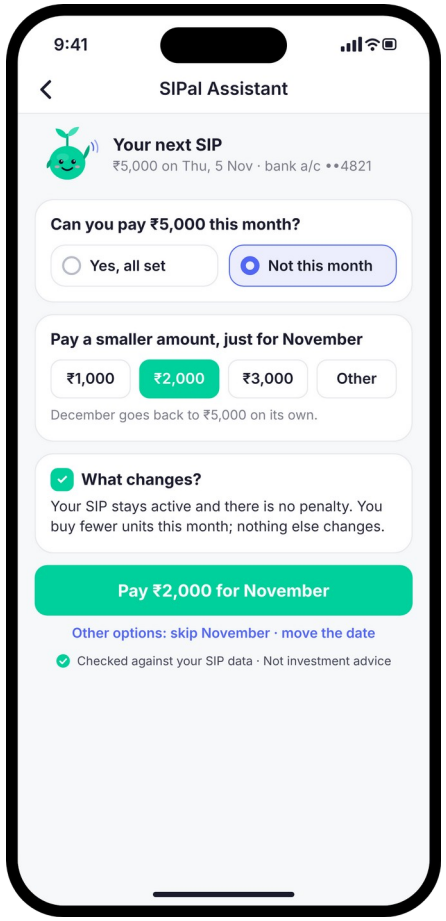
Calm, not pushy

- One reminder per instalment, no countdowns or red alerts
- "Yes, all set" closes it in one tap
- Skip and cancel stay visible and easy



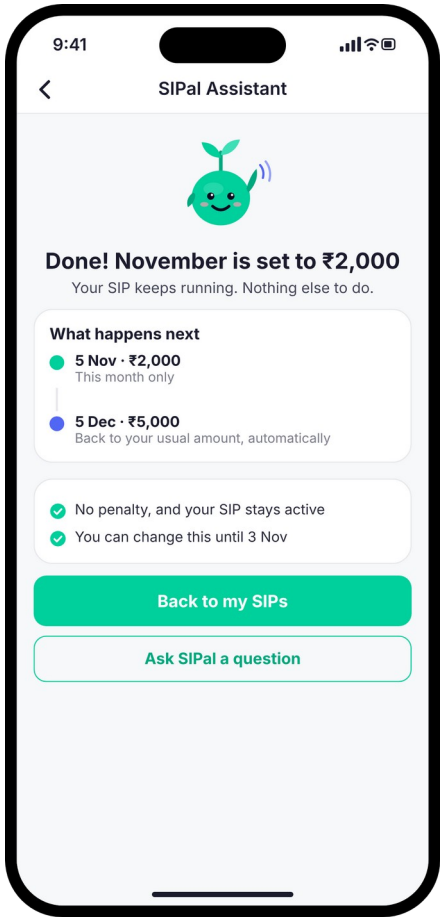
1 Reminder, 3 days before

Early enough for a change to go through



2 Pay less this month

A smaller amount, for this month only

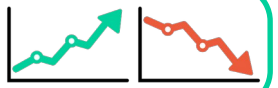


3 Confirmed

Next month goes back to the usual amount

Risks: SIPal's main risks are advice drift, wrong explanations and pushy nudges, and each has a built-in safeguard

Success: +2 to +4 points on the 12-month active SIP rate (estimate), tracked by first-try debit success and the stop-to-adjust rate.



1 Read as investment advice

Mitigation: Advice and prediction requests get a fixed decline and a pointer to a SEBI-registered adviser. No fund names; “not investment advice” on every screen.

17/17 safety tests; 20/20 golden answers advice-free

2 Wrong or invented explanations

Mitigation: The AI only words the facts and rules it is given. Every number must match them; a failed check shows the standard text instead.

Gap: checks numbers and phrases, not every paraphrase

3 Too cautious to be useful

Mitigation: If unsure, SIPal points to an official source instead of guessing. Fallback rate is tracked; the golden set is re-run after every prompt change.

19/20 golden-set match; one tip wrongly declined

4 Pushy or too many alerts

Mitigation: Weekly, not daily. One reminder per instalment, “Not now” and mute. Urgency words are blocked; skip and cancel are never hidden.

Guardrail: mute rate and time to cancel

5 Demo data, not real accounts

Mitigation: SIP numbers and market moves are labelled sample data. Launch needs Groww's portfolio data, a vetted market feed and fund-house support for paying less.

Next: pilot on real data, behind a flag

6 Privacy and free-tier limits

Mitigation: No login and no PAN; personal details are refused and nothing is stored. Rate limits, caching and fixed fallback text keep it working if the AI is down.

PAN test refused; fallback works if the AI is down

Live MVP: **Try SIPal** Release gate: golden-set match 80%+, every shown answer advice-free, every advice request declined.